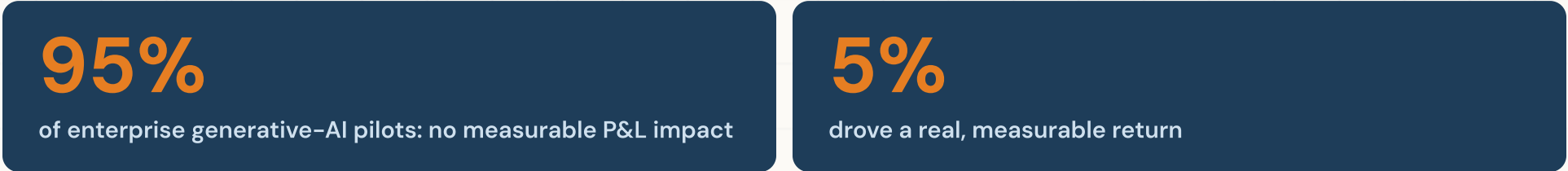


95% of AI pilots fail. What the other 5% did.

MIT NANDA put a number on it: ~95% of enterprise generative-AI pilots showed no measurable P&L impact, and ~5% drove a real return. Both groups had the same kinds of models at the same time, and what separated them was how each company ran underneath the AI.

THE HEADLINE NUMBER MIT NANDA · Aug 2025



MIT NANDA, "The GenAI Divide: State of AI in Business 2025." 150 executive interviews, a 350-person survey, 300 public deployments. Treat the headline number as a strong signal and read the source yourself, because its method has been questioned in public too.

READ AS

AI doesn't work.

ACTUALLY

The operation around it wasn't ready.

THREE ROOT CAUSES - THE REPORT'S OWN none of them are model problems

- 1

The learning gap
Dropped in without the structure to improve.
 - No process, no feedback loop, no owner – so it stalls instead of getting better.
- 2

Budget misalignment
The budget went to the wrong places.
 - Over half the spend went to sales and marketing, while the measurable returns came from back-office work.
- 3

Build versus buy
Bought and partnered beat built in-house.
 - Teams that bought from specialists or partnered succeeded roughly 2x as often as teams that built it all themselves.

THE DIVIDE five layers, one framework



The five percent had these in place. The ninety-five percent went straight to the model without them.

Monday morning YOUR FIRST MOVE

Before you fund the next pilot, or greenlight the one a vendor is pitching this quarter, take the one use case you care about most and ask: "can our operation run this once it's live?"

Walk it against the five layers, honestly: governed, clean data, standard process, controls, a named owner for the day after launch. Self-check: wherever you hesitate is the layer to fix before you fund it.

OPERATOR INSIGHT · SEASON 2

"The line between the 5% and the 95% was never the model. It was the operation underneath it."

"Your AI maturity will never exceed your operational maturity."

Free

Score your own operation – the AI-Ready Operations Assessment runs it on your systems. vihrenlabs.gumroad.com/l/rmkje